EASYCUT

CREATOR PLAYBOOK / 06



ENGLISH / US EDITION

Why Your Shorts Aren’t Getting Views

From exposure to conversion, identify weak points and transform your next video with a single targeted fix.

AI-generated illustrative creator

36 PAGES / 2026 EDITION

Read This First

Low views are a symptom, not the root cause.

If your views are low and you overhaul your entire editing style, you may miss the real reason and lose any lessons learned.

1. Start with clear definitions.
Each platform counts views, reach, and active views differently.

2. Compare like with like.
Compare videos from the same channel, with similar length, format, and time frame.

3. Focus on patterns, not just numbers.
Instead of reacting to a single outlier, look for recurring weak points across your last 10 videos.

4. Change one thing at a time.
Only adjust one element-topic, opening shot, structure, or reward-so you can track what caused any change.

The sections, timeframes, and scores in this book are practical frameworks for creators. They are not platform guarantees or absolute standards.

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Diagnosis starts from the beginning

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Five Key Symptoms

Divide possible causes into five steps:

1. Exposure
Barely appears in feeds
Topic, eligibility, source

2. Pause
Shown but instantly skipped
Opening shot, hook, promise

3. Retention
Viewers drop off after the start
Structure, rhythm, clarity

4. Reaction
People finish but don’t share
Reward, sharing, comments

5. Conversion
There’s engagement, but no subscriptions
Channel promise, CTA

If a step is blocked, you won’t have enough data to interpret metrics from later steps.

The Diagnosis Map

Look for bottlenecks before fixating on view counts.

Find the weakest metric, review the scenes where it drops, and change only one variable in your next video.

SIGNAL
Which metric is underperforming?

SCENE
Where in the video does the drop-off occur?

TEST
What single element will you change in the next upload?

The goal of diagnosis isn’t to blame past videos, but to narrow down your options for the next one.

Decision Tree for Diagnosis

Start with the first question where you fail, not where you succeed:

1. Did your video appear in enough feeds?
No → Diagnose exposure

2. Did people who saw it choose to watch?
No → Diagnose pause

3. Did viewers stay until the promised reward?
No → Diagnose retention

4. Did they have a reason to share or save it?
No → Diagnose reaction

5. Did they have a reason to revisit your channel?
No → Diagnose conversion

Begin your fix at the first 'No' you encounter, not the first 'Yes.'

How to Use This Book

You only need to apply one page per video.

1. Set Your Baseline
Group your latest 10 videos by similar format and length, then write down the median value.

2. Find the First Drop-Off Point
Review in order: exposure → drop-off → retention → engagement → conversion.

3. Check by Scene
Rewatch the sentence, screen, or transition just before the graph dips.

4. Choose One Solution
Pick only one to try: first frame, hook sentence, middle structure, or reward.

5. Record and Repeat
Summarize the initial, 24-hour, and 7-day performance and what you learned in one line.

If your diagnosis shows two possible causes, experiment starting with the earlier stage that has more impact.

Part 01: Low Exposure

Start by checking if your video had a chance to appear in the feed.

First question of this part:
Did your video have an opportunity to show up in the feed?

Diagnosis order: Check signals → Check scenes → Apply one variable solution.

Part 01: Baseline

Turn 'low' into numbers.

Don’t compare to a single viral hit. Instead, compare to the median of your last 10 videos.

1. Comparison Group
Same channel, similar length, same format.

2. Observation Window
Initial signals, 24 hours, and 7-day totals.

3. Representative Value
Median of your last 10 videos + range of your top 3 videos.

4. Diagnosis Statement
Instead of 'low views,' say 'feed exposure is half the baseline.'

The median is less affected by one or two big successes or failures, making it a good operating standard for small channels.

Part 01: Traffic Source

Distinguish between lack of exposure and traffic structure issues.

Shorts Feed
Core area for recommendation testing.
Shown in feed or chosen for viewing.

Search
Long-term value for question/problem-solving topics.
Match keywords and titles.

Home/Recommendations
Connects to previous viewing history and topic.
Repeat topics or series.

Channel/Subscribers
Return visits from people who already know you.
Subscriber response and channel consistency.

External
Shares, embeds, other social media.

Viewing Quality by Source
If feed exposure is low, before changing just the first frame, check your topic, eligibility for recommendations, and repeatable format.

Part 01: Recommendation Eligibility

First, check if your content is eligible for recommendations.

- Account and post are public, with age and region settings matching your intent.
- No warning about account status or recommendation eligibility on the platform.
- No copyright, community, or recommendation guideline violation notices.
- Doesn’t appear to be a watermark, low-quality reupload, or repeated duplicate.
- Title, hashtags, and description match the actual video content.
- No excessive sensitive or misleading scenes on the first screen.
- No technical issues with upload processing, music restrictions, or visibility settings.

Being eligible doesn’t guarantee recommendations, but eligibility restrictions are the top priority when diagnosing exposure issues.

Part 01: Topic Demand Score

Score your topic for watch-worthiness before editing.

1/5 Clarity of Problem
One sentence describing who faces what problem.

2/5 Timeliness
A topic people are currently asking or searching for repeatedly.

3/5 Evidence
Able to show results, screens, numbers, or examples.

4/5 Difference
A new perspective, verification, or selection criteria compared to existing answers.

5/5 Expandability
Can be continued into at least three follow-up videos.

The score isn’t a pass/fail line, but a tool to pick the top 3 out of 10 topic candidates to make first.

Exposure Remedies by Symptom

Choose your initial remedy based on the specific symptom.

Symptom: Very low feed exposure
Possible causes: Eligibility, topic, or repetitive format issues
First remedy: Create a 3-part series with the same format

Symptom: Only getting search traffic
Possible causes: Weak tension or opening visuals for recommendations
First remedy: Start with results or contrasting scenes

Symptom: Only subscribers are watching
Possible causes: Lack of context for non-subscribers
First remedy: Start with the problem instead of specific names

Symptom: Mostly external traffic
Possible causes: Mismatch with internal platform demand
First remedy: Check internal search terms and feed response

Prescription log: For the next 3 videos, keep ___ / change ___ / success metric ___

Check If Viewers Stop Early

Make sure the topic and reason to watch are clear in the very first moments.

First question for this section:
Did the opening instantly communicate the topic and why to watch?

Diagnosis steps: Check the signals → Review the opening scene → Apply one variable remedy

Diagnosing Missed First Impressions

If your video appears in the feed but isn't watched, review the opening moments.

"Shown in feed" means you got the opportunity; "chosen to watch" is the viewer's first judgment.

1. Topic isn't clear
Viewers can't tell what the video is about from the first frame.

2. Outcome isn't clear
It's unclear what change, answer, or feeling viewers will get by watching to the end.

3. Target audience isn't clear
The first sentence doesn't say who the information is for.

4. Trust isn't established
Exaggeration, vague statements, or clickbait appear before any evidence.

YouTube Studio's 'How many chose to view' shows both the view rate and the skip rate.

Aligning Title, Visuals, and Opening

Your title, first visual, and opening line must all make the same promise.

Title
What problem are you solving, and for whom?
Example: Why beginner Shorts creators get stuck at zero views

First visual
Do you show the result, contrast, or action first?
Example: The sharp drop point on the retention curve

First caption
Are you starting to prove your point, not just copying the title?
Example: The real issue isn't views, it's right here

First spoken line
Do you start with conflict, conclusion, or an experiment-without greetings?
Example: I compared my last 10 uploads

Capture your first frame and place it next to your title. If they seem like different promises, redesign them for consistency.

Six-Point Hook Checklist

Check your first two seconds with these six questions:

- Can you tell the topic just by looking at the first frame?
- Does the first sentence include a result, problem, or difference?
- Can viewers instantly judge if it's relevant to them?
- Do visuals and captions complement each other without repeating information?
- Does the proof start immediately, without greetings, logos, or background explanations?
- Do you spark curiosity without endlessly delaying the conclusion?

If you score four or fewer, before adding effects, remake your first visual, sentence, or action.

Turning Abstract Hooks Into Clear Promises

Change vague statements into testable promises.

BEFORE:
Today I'll tell you about Shorts
AFTER:
If your Shorts have low views, they're getting stuck at one of these five points
Remedy: Broad topic → Diagnostic promise

BEFORE:
Why is the algorithm like this?
AFTER:
Let's separate feed exposure from viewer choice
Remedy: Vague question → Measurable element

BEFORE:
You'll be amazed if you watch to the end
AFTER:
I'll show you the 7-second scene that caused the sharp drop at the end
Remedy: Exaggeration → Specific scene

A strong hook isn't about making big claims-it's about quickly showing what viewers will actually see or learn.

A/B/C Hook Testing

Keep the main content fixed and create three types of hooks only.

A · Result Type
The number you should check before views is this one.
First frame _____ | First action _____

B · Diagnostic Type
Where did your Shorts get stuck among these five spots?
First frame _____ | First action _____

C · Evidence Type
I overlaid the retention curves of the last 10 videos on one screen.
First frame _____ | First action _____

Keep the topic, main content, length, and reward the same.
Match posting conditions and comparison periods as closely as possible.
Test the winning sentence structure again with the next topic.

Diagnosing Early Drop-Offs

Find the scene just before the retention curve drops and prescribe a structural fix.

HOLD
First question of this section:
Find the scene just before the curve dips and prescribe a structural solution.

Diagnosis order: Check the signal → Check the scene → Adjust one variable.

Reading the Retention Curve

Check the scene just before the curve drops, not just the shape.

Early sharp drop:
- Delayed promise or mismatch with first frame

Mid-video rebound:
- Possible rewinding, sharing, or lack of understanding

Drop in specific section:
- Repetitive explanation, context switch, or readability issues

YouTube retention data usually takes 1-2 days to process. Don’t judge an empty graph right after upload as a failure.

Drop-Off Patterns and Fixes

Turn curve shapes into scene-based questions.

Vertical drop:
- Did a new context, ad, greeting, or repetition appear at that moment?
Prescription: Delete or move up the scene.

Stepwise drop:
- Does the topic change at every transition without a clear promise?
Prescription: Add a transition sentence.

Long, gentle decline:
- Is the same explanation continuing without new information?
Prescription: Compress beats or swap examples.

Late sharp drop:
- Did viewers already know the conclusion, or was the CTA too long?
Prescription: End right after the conclusion.

Not every spike is a good sign. Check the scene to see if viewers rewatched because they liked it, or rewound because they didn’t understand.

15-45 Second Scene Map

Each section should set up the reason for the next scene.

0-2 seconds
Promise
Problem or result

2-7 seconds
Evidence
Actual footage

7-20 seconds
Development
Method or comparison

20-35 seconds
Transition
New information

35-45 seconds
Reward
Conclusion or action

Delete:
Can the next scene be understood if this one is removed?

Transition:
Is there new information, visuals, or progress every 5-8 seconds?

Reward:
Does the final scene answer the initial promise?

If shortening the length also reduces understanding, it’s omission, not compression.

Clarity Prescriptions

Quick understanding is more important than quick cuts.

1. Subtitles
One meaning per screen, highlight keywords, keep within safe area

2. Visuals
Show the subject, process, or result slightly before the audio

3. Voice
Don’t cut off sentence endings; pause before and after key words

4. Effects
Use only to highlight new information, transitions, or evidence

5. Background Music
Don’t drown out the voice; only support emotional shifts

If you can understand the topic from a muted screenshot, and follow the flow with your eyes closed, visuals and audio are complementing, not depending on, each other.

Pinpointing Retention Drop-Offs

Look at the 7 seconds just before your retention curve drops sharply. Note any changes in script, visuals, captions, or transitions-these are your candidates for removal or revision in your next video.

BEFORE
3 seconds before drop-off

POINT
The exact moment of decline

AFTER
Reward for those who stayed

More important than a single sharp drop are recurring patterns across multiple videos, such as scenes right after greetings, before examples, or at the start of a call to action (CTA). These repeated moments are key signals to focus on.

Does Completion Lead to Sharing?

Check if viewers who finish your video are motivated to share, save, or discuss it.

RESPONSE
First question of this section:
Does the value at the end of your video lead to sharing, saving, or conversation?

Diagnosis steps: Identify signals → Review scenes → Adjust one variable

What Value Remains After Watching?

For a completed view to lead to sharing, it must leave behind value:

1. Practical Value
A checklist, sequence, or phrase viewers want to save and reuse.

2. Shareable Value
Information that instantly makes you think of someone to send it to.

3. Judgment Value
Criteria for comparison or warnings about what to avoid.

4. Emotional Value
Moments that spark empathy, surprise, relief, or laughter.

A video is more likely to spread when viewers think not just 'That was useful,' but 'Who should I send this to, and why?'

Read the Reasons Behind Engagement

Focus on why viewers engage, not just how many likes you get.

Share
Why someone would send this to a specific person
Design elements: Target audience, problem, one-sentence summary

Save
Why someone would want to revisit or reuse this
Design elements: Sequence, tools, templates

Comment
Why someone would add their experience, judgment, or question
Design elements: Multiple-choice questions, requests for examples

Rewatch
Why someone would watch again or try to follow along
Design elements: Details, actions, rapid information

If you see lots of comments but they're mostly asking for clarification, that's a sign of unclear content-not viral potential.

Matching CTAs to Viewer Response

If you get engagement but not subscriptions, review your next-step promises:

Subscribe
Make a specific promise about the next related video.
Example: Next up, we'll compare three hooks in action.

Save
Ask for a save only at moments viewers will want to revisit.
Example: Double-check these six things before uploading.

Comment
Ask a question that can be answered in one sentence.
Example: Which is your weakest area-feed, hook, or retention?

Profile
Clarify what viewers gain and where to find it.
Example: Get the full diagnostic chart from my profile link.

Your CTA should be a natural next step after delivering value. Only ask for one action per video.

Test, Adjust, and Measure Again

Change one variable, then remeasure using the same baseline.

TEST & LEARN
First question of this section:
Change one variable, then remeasure using the same baseline.

Diagnosis steps: Identify signals → Review scenes → Adjust one variable

One-Variable Experiment Method

Apply only one change at a time.

The more things you change at once, the harder it is to know what actually caused the improvement.

1. Fixed Elements
Topic · Main content · Length · Reward · Posting conditions

2. Variable
Change only one: either the first frame, the first sentence, or one structural element in the middle.

3. Evaluation
Pick one metric to judge: Feed impressions · Chosen views · Retention · Shares

4. Timeframe
Compare signals over the same window: Initial signal · 24 hours · 7-day trend

5. Learning
Instead of just noting if it got better or worse, write down one sentence you can reuse in your next video.

Platform Metric Definitions

Do not compare raw view counts 1:1 across platforms.

YouTube
Views: Counts when playback or replay starts.
Related metrics: Engaged views, Shown in feed, Chosen views

Instagram
Views: Counts when played or displayed.
Related metrics: Accounts reached, Interactions

TikTok
Views: Check the in-app definition.
Related metrics: Watch time, Completion, Source, Search response

As of March 31, 2025, YouTube Shorts counts a view as any playback or replay start, with no minimum watch time. The previous method is now labeled as Engaged views.

On Instagram, 'Accounts reached' is the number of unique accounts that have seen your content at least once, while 'Views' can include multiple plays by the same account.

Easy Cut Diagnosis Loop

Find videos that are taking off and keep improving weak spots in a loop.

Connect these steps in a cycle:
- Discover trending videos in real time
- Analyze highlights using AI
- Auto-create Shorts
- Record performance

Steps:
Discovery: Topics that are starting to get traction
Analysis: Highlights and structure
Production: First scene, captions, cuts
Learning: Weak metrics, next steps

Find what works, and turn it into a Short right away.

14-Day Diagnosis Plan

3 days of observation, 7 days for changes, 4 days for review

D1-3 Baseline
Group your last 10 videos · Find the median · Identify the first failure point

D4-5 Identify Causes
Check the scene before the graph drops · Review comments · Check traffic sources

D6-7 Design Changes
Set fixed variables · Choose one variable to change · Pick one evaluation metric

D8-11 Experiment
Post 3 videos with the same format, changing only one variable

D12-14 Review & Repeat
Check 24-hour and 7-day trends · Decide the next experiment

The goal is not to guarantee a viral video in 14 days, but to find one change you can repeat in your next 10 videos.

Final 15-Point Diagnosis Checklist

15 questions to review after upload

Exposure
01 Feed impressions are similar to baseline
02 No issues with recommendation eligibility or public settings
03 There is evidence of demand for the topic

Stopping Points
04 The first frame shows the topic and result
05 Title and first sentence make the same promise
06 Chosen views are similar to baseline

Retention
07 Marked the scene just before a sharp drop
08 Checked for repetition, context switches, readability
09 The ending answers the initial promise

Response
10 Clear reasons for sharing or saving
11 Positive signals in comments
12 Identified why certain scenes are rewatched

Experiment
13 Only one variable was changed
14 Evaluation metric and timeframe were set
15 Wrote one sentence of learning for the next video

The first 'No' you find is your next area to fix.
Change only one variable, and use the same checklist to compare again.

Official sources

Open a title to read the official guidance. Recheck current terms before applying or publishing.

YouTube Shorts Getting Started & View Counting

support.google.com

YouTube Shorts Content Analysis

support.google.com

YouTube Key Moments in Audience Retention

support.google.com

Instagram Insights

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TikTok Creator Search Insights

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